

IT Change and Supplier Management Procedure

Organisation	North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU)
Version	1.6
Status	CURRENT
Effective date	01 March 2026
Policy owner	Head of Technology
Classification	Synthetic training material

Document control note: users must confirm status and effective date before relying on a rule. Superseded documents are retained in this synthetic corpus deliberately so that retrieval pipelines can be tested for version awareness.

1. Change Classification

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies change classification in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
1.1	Changes are classified as standard, normal or emergency according to risk, repeatability and urgency.
1.2	A change affecting lending rules, payment files or member data is never treated as low impact solely because the code change is small.
1.3	Dependencies and rollback requirements must be identified before deployment.

Control 1. Changes are classified as standard, normal or emergency according to risk, repeatability and urgency. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. A change affecting lending rules, payment files or member data is never treated as low impact solely because the code change is small. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Dependencies and rollback requirements must be identified before deployment. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

2. Testing and Approval

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies testing and approval in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
2.1	Rule changes require traceable test cases covering boundary values, negative scenarios and existing products.
2.2	A lending threshold change must include tests immediately below, at and immediately above the threshold.
2.3	Business approval must confirm that implemented rules match the approved policy.

Control 1. Rule changes require traceable test cases covering boundary values, negative scenarios and existing products. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. A lending threshold change must include tests immediately below, at and immediately above the threshold. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Business approval must confirm that implemented rules match the approved policy. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

3. Payment and Payroll Interfaces

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies payment and payroll interfaces in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
3.1	Inbound and outbound payment files require reconciliation of record count and value.

Ref	Key requirement
3.2	A material variance between expected and received payroll deductions must be alerted and investigated.
3.3	Failed files must not be silently reprocessed without duplicate controls.

Control 1. Inbound and outbound payment files require reconciliation of record count and value. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. A material variance between expected and received payroll deductions must be alerted and investigated. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Failed files must not be silently reprocessed without duplicate controls. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

4. Supplier Management

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies supplier management in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
4.1	Critical suppliers require service monitoring, incident escalation contacts and periodic due diligence.
4.2	Supplier outages must be linked to impacted business services and member populations.
4.3	Repeated incidents require formal service-improvement action.

Control 1. Critical suppliers require service monitoring, incident escalation contacts and periodic due diligence. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Supplier outages must be linked to impacted business services and member populations. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Repeated incidents require formal service-improvement action. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

5. Post-Implementation Review

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies post-implementation review in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
5.1	High-risk changes require post-implementation review using operational and member-outcome indicators.
5.2	Unexpected approval-rate, arrears, complaint or payment changes should be compared with the implementation date.
5.3	Defects must be recorded with impact and remediation.

Control 1. High-risk changes require post-implementation review using operational and member-outcome indicators. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Unexpected approval-rate, arrears, complaint or payment changes should be compared with the implementation date. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Defects must be recorded with impact and remediation. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

6. Management Information

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies management information in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
6.1	Technology MI should include change success, emergency changes, incidents, supplier SLA, payment exceptions and open defects.
6.2	Material incidents must be cross-referenced to operational-risk reporting.
6.3	A change can be technically successful but operationally unsuccessful if member outcomes deteriorate.

Control 1. Technology MI should include change success, emergency changes, incidents, supplier SLA, payment exceptions and open defects. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Material incidents must be cross-referenced to operational-risk reporting. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. A change can be technically successful but operationally unsuccessful if member outcomes deteriorate. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

End of synthetic document